

Research Plan & Teacher Questionnaire: School Management System & Website Adoption

School: Nyazura Adventist School

Document Purpose: This document combines a **research framework** and a **detailed teacher questionnaire** to investigate why teachers are reluctant to use the School Management System (SMS) and website, and to guide practical interventions that will improve adoption, usability, and value.

All responses are confidential and will be used solely to improve the system to better support teaching and learning.

Part 1: Research Objectives

1. Identify Technical Barriers

- Detect system bugs, errors, or failures (e.g. data not saving, login issues).
- Assess internet reliability, power availability, and device compatibility.
- Understand performance issues such as slow loading or downtime.

2. Assess Usability (User Experience – UX)

- Determine whether the system is intuitive or overly complex.
- Identify steps or workflows that take too long to complete.
- Assess mobile usability, clarity of menus, and navigation flow.

3. Feature Gap Analysis

- Identify which features teachers actually use and value.
- Discover missing features that would directly reduce teacher workload.
- Prioritise features that provide immediate time-saving benefits.

4. Evaluate Institutional Culture & Readiness

- Assess adequacy of training and onboarding.
 - Identify perceptions of the system as “extra work” vs a productivity tool.
 - Measure leadership support, policy clarity, and enforcement.
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Part 2: Teacher Questionnaire

Section A: Background & User Profile

1. Your role at the school (tick one):

- ☐ Teacher
- ☐ Senior Teacher / HOD
- ☐ Administrator
- ☐ Other (please specify): ____

2. Department / Subject Area: ____

3. Teaching experience:

- ☐ Less than 2 years
- ☐ 2–5 years
- ☐ 6–10 years
- ☐ More than 10 years

4. Level of computer/technology confidence:

- ☐ Beginner
 - ☐ Intermediate
 - ☐ Advanced
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Section B: Awareness, Access & Usage

1. Are you aware that the school has a School Management System / website?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

2. On average, how often do you log into the system?

- ☐ Daily
- ☐ Weekly
- ☐ Rarely
- ☐ Never

3. Have you ever logged into or used the system?

- ☐ Yes, regularly
- ☐ Yes, occasionally
- ☐ Tried once or twice
- ☐ Never

4. If used, what did you mainly use it for? (Tick all that apply)

- ☐ Student records

- ☐ Attendance
 - ☐ Marks / results entry
 - ☐ Communication / notices
 - ☐ Other: ____
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Section C: Technical Issues & Accessibility

1. What is the primary device you use to access the system?
 - ☐ Smartphone
 - ☐ Laptop
 - ☐ Desktop computer
 - ☐ Tablet
 2. On a scale of 1–5, how stable is the system when you use it?
(1 = *Constant problems*, 5 = *Very stable*)
1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5 ☐
 3. Have you experienced any of the following? (Tick all that apply)
 - ☐ Slow loading times
 - ☐ Login or password errors
 - ☐ Data not saving after entry
 - ☐ System freezing or crashing
 - ☐ Buttons or menus not working on mobile
 - ☐ Formatting/layout issues (overlapping text, misaligned pages)
 - ☐ None of the above
 4. How often do internet or power issues affect your ability to use online systems?
 - ☐ Very often
 - ☐ Sometimes
 - ☐ Rarely
 - ☐ Never
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Section D: Reasons for Reluctance & Perceptions

1. What are the main reasons you are reluctant to use the system? (Tick all that apply)
 - ☐ I was not properly trained
 - ☐ The system is difficult to use
 - ☐ Tasks take too long to complete
 - ☐ Internet/connectivity issues
 - ☐ I don't see its value in my daily work
 - ☐ Prefer manual / paper-based methods
 - ☐ Fear of making mistakes

- ☐ Lack of technical support
- ☐ Other: ____

2. *"I feel the system adds more work to my day rather than saving time."*

- ☐ Strongly Agree
- ☐ Agree
- ☐ Neutral
- ☐ Disagree
- ☐ Strongly Disagree

3. What is the BIGGEST single reason you avoid using the system?

- ☐ I don't understand how to use it (need training)
- ☐ It takes too long to perform simple tasks
- ☐ I prefer paper/manual methods
- ☐ I don't see clear benefits for students or teachers

Section E: Training & Support

1. Did you receive training on how to use the system?

- ☐ Yes (sufficient)
- ☐ Yes (but not enough)
- ☐ No training at all

2. What support would help you use the system confidently? (Tick all that apply)

- ☐ Hands-on workshops
- ☐ Step-by-step guides/manuals
- ☐ Short video tutorials
- ☐ On-site technical support
- ☐ WhatsApp/phone support
- ☐ Peer support from trained teachers

Section F: Features, Value & Expectations

1. Which current features do you find most useful?

1. Which features are so difficult to use that you avoid them?

1. What NEW features would make your job easier? (*Rank your top 3*)

- ☐ Automated report generation
- ☐ Mobile-friendly attendance marking

- ☐ Direct messaging to parents/students
- ☐ Easy lesson plan & scheme uploads
- ☐ Offline mode (work now, sync later)
- ☐ Student performance analytics
- ☐ Bulk SMS / announcements
- ☐ Other: ____

2. What ONE feature would save you the most time each week?

Section G: Leadership, Policy & Adoption

1. Do you feel the use of the system is clearly supported by school leadership?
 - ☐ Yes
 - ☐ Somewhat
 - ☐ No

 2. Would clear school policies requiring system use improve adoption?
 - ☐ Yes
 - ☐ No
 - ☐ Not sure

 3. What would motivate you MOST to use the system consistently?
 - ☐ It clearly saves time
 - ☐ Proper training
 - ☐ Reliable technical support
 - ☐ Management support & enforcement
 - ☐ Ease of use
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Section H: Open Feedback

1. In your own words, what is the biggest problem with the current system?

1. Any additional suggestions on how the system or website can be improved?

Part 3: Interview Guide – School Representative (Mr. Mpinya)

Use these guiding questions during the scheduled discussion:

1. **Nature of Resistance:** Is teacher pushback mostly verbal (complaints) or passive (non-usage)?
2. **Infrastructure Reality:** Do teachers have reliable internet access, power, and working devices?

3. **Training History:** What onboarding or training was provided at launch?
 4. **High-Impact Automation:** Which manual task do teachers dislike most that could be automated?
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Part 4: Proposed Strategy for the School Visit

1. The “Pain Point” Workshop

- Teachers demonstrate real problems live.
- Focus on listening rather than convincing.

2. Live Debugging & Quick Wins

- Fix minor issues on the spot.
- Show immediate responsiveness to concerns.

3. Incentive-Based Adoption

- Highlight 1–2 features that save at least 30 minutes per day.
 - Position the system as a workload reducer, not an obligation.
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